

If I could start my life again, I would begin by changing my profession. I would rather live on a full stomach and an empty mind. Perhaps as a fisherman." Thus goes a line which essays the essence of the play, *The Skeleton Woman*. It is the result of a theatrical journey undertaken by actors Kalki Koechlin and Prashant Prakash about a year ago. The play won them the Metro Playwright Award for 2009. Produced by Anurag Kashyap and directed by Nayantra Kotian, it delves between the lines of fiction and reality. The set design and staging help in furthering the unrealistic world inhabited by the writer and his wife. The seaside is

brought to life innovatively by the shell of a boat on stage. The exploratory piece is inspired by an Inuit folk tale and features the life of a writer (Prakash) caught between real life and his characters as he finds himself losing his grip on both as well as his wife (Koechlin) who is constantly trying to bring him back to earth. The writers, who are also the performers, describe the play rightly as a work about "love, loneliness and what one must endure to be happy". *The Skeleton Woman* will be regularly performed in Mumbai at Prithvi Theatre and will be travelling to Chennai and Bangalore in the next few months.

by Nirmala Ravindran

Nights at the Opera

Spend your Saturday evenings watching Cesare declare his undying love for Cleopatra. Celebrating the 75th year of the Glyndebourne Festival Opera, BIG Cinemas, in association with More 2 Screen is bringing three of the Glyndebourne Festival Opera's productions to India, starting June 21. On offer is George Frideric Handel's *Cesare and*

Cleopatra, Jacopo Ferretti's libretto based on *Cinderella* and a tribute to Italian tenor Luciano Pavarotti. Shot in Dolby Digital sound, the operas are all in Italian but will come with English subtitles. The shows will also be screened in BIG Cinema halls in Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata, Ahmedabad and Pune.

Giulio Cesare: One of Handel's most lavishly scored works, it won the 2006 South Bank Show Award for Best Opera. The part-history part-comedy opera is a study of political manoeuvring as Caesar's Romans meet Cleopatra's Egyptians.

La Cenerentola: Italian composer Gioachino Rossini's much-loved comic opera will see Glyndebourne's music director Vladimir Jurowski and Sir Peter Hall unite in this timeless social comedy.

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by Aditi Pai



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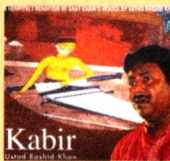
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by S. Sahaya Ranjit